

DongFunBuBai's Origin Story



The moon hid behind thick storm clouds, leaving the ancient forest shrouded in darkness. It was the Hour of Zi—the dead of night, when spirits were said to roam and even seasoned martial artists avoided the lonely mountain trails.

The silence was shattered by frantic footsteps.

A lone man, his robes torn and soaked with blood, sprinted through the ancient forest. His breathing was ragged, his face pale from blood loss, yet his eyes burned with unwavering determination. His left hand clutched a long bundle wrapped tightly in faded black cloth, while his right pressed desperately against the deep sword wound across his chest.

Behind him, five hooded figures gave relentless chase.

Each moved with extraordinary qinggong, their feet barely touching the ground as they leaped from branch to branch like phantoms in the night. Though their faces were hidden beneath dark hoods, the murderous intent radiating from them chilled the very air.

"There!"

"He cannot escape!"

The leader extended his arm.

Cold steel flashed through the darkness.

Whoosh!

Three throwing daggers cut through the night like shooting stars.

"STOP RIGHT THERE!" the leader roared.

The fleeing man twisted his body just in time.

One dagger grazed his shoulder.

Another buried itself into the trunk of an ancient pine.

The third struck deeply into his back.

"Ugh!"

He stumbled, nearly collapsing, but forced himself onward. Every step left crimson footprints upon the forest floor.

Soon, the trees began to thin.

The roaring sound of rushing water echoed through the mountains.

The man emerged onto the edge of a towering cliff.

Before him lay a vast abyss, where a raging waterfall plunged hundreds of feet into the river below. Mist rose endlessly from its base, concealing everything beneath.

He had reached a dead end.

The five assassins landed behind him one after another, forming a semicircle that sealed every escape.

"There is nowhere left to run," the leader sneered.

"Hand over the item."

"We may grant you a swift death."

The wounded man slowly turned.

Blood trickled from the corner of his lips as he looked from one assassin to another. Despite his grievous injuries, there was neither fear nor surrender in his eyes.

Instead...

He smiled.

A faint, almost mocking smile.

"You?"

His voice was weak but steady.

"You are... not worthy."

The assassins' expressions darkened.

"Kill him!"

The five lunged forward simultaneously.

Swords, sabers, and hidden weapons converged upon him from every direction.

Yet at that very instant, the wounded man gathered the last remnants of his inner qi.

With a single powerful step, he launched himself backward.

His body soared beyond the edge of the cliff.

The assassins froze.

"No!"

"He jumped!"

His figure disappeared into the roaring mist below.

A heartbeat later—

BOOM!

The thunderous waterfall swallowed him whole.

The assassins rushed to the precipice and peered into the abyss.

Nothing could be seen beyond the endless curtain of white water crashing into the river below.

"Search downstream."

"Whether alive or dead..."

"The item must be recovered."

Without another word, the five shadows vanished into the darkness, following the river's course.

Several li downstream, where the river flowed gently through a secluded valley, the battered body of the man drifted helplessly with the current before finally washing ashore among a bed of reeds.

His complexion was deathly pale.

His breathing was so faint it was nearly imperceptible.

The wounds covering his body told the tale of countless battles. Sword cuts, hidden weapon injuries, and severe internal damage left little hope that any man could survive.

Yet somehow...

He still clung to life.

As the first light of dawn painted the eastern sky, a young woman made her way toward the river carrying a wooden bucket.

She wore flowing robes of pristine white embroidered with pale blue lotus blossoms. A jade hairpin held her raven-black hair neatly in place, while a slender sword rested quietly at her waist. Every movement she made possessed an effortless grace, as though she were gliding across the earth rather than walking.

She was Heka, the First Senior Disciple of the GNS Clan.

Throughout the Jianghu, her name was spoken with admiration. Renowned for both her exceptional swordsmanship and gentle demeanor, many regarded her as one of the Six Great Beauties of Jianghu, women whose elegance was said to rival that of celestial maidens.

She had come to the river at her master's request to fetch fresh mountain water.

Instead...

Fate placed something else before her.

As she knelt beside the riverbank, her eyes caught sight of a motionless figure tangled among the reeds.

Her expression immediately changed.

Setting aside the bucket, she hurried to his side.

The man's pulse was so faint it could scarcely be felt.

His robes were soaked with blood, and his body bore wounds from swords, daggers, and what appeared to be the crushing impact of a tremendous fall. By all reason, he should have died long ago.

Yet his hand remained tightly wrapped around a long bundle covered in black cloth, refusing to release it even in unconsciousness.

"What could have happened to you?" Heka murmured softly.

Only the murmur of the river answered.

Unable to abandon a dying man, Heka carefully lifted him onto her shoulder and began the journey back to her master's secluded residence.

She could not have known that the stranger she had just rescued carried a secret powerful enough to shake the foundations of the Jianghu.

Nor could she have foreseen that this single act of compassion would entwine her fate, the fate of the GNS Clan, and the destiny of the entire martial world.

